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A LOSING BET

THE HOUSE FAVORITES

HOW CASINOS ARE EXPLOITING ASIAN COMMUNITIES FOR PROFIT



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

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The late-morning sun was already high and hot over the brownstones in Boston's Chinatown neighborhood when a sleek bus pulled to a stop at a mostly deserted street corner.

Five dozen people emerged from under store awnings and from shaded alleyways to clamor for one of 60 seats on the air-conditioned bus, set for a day of money-risking and, for most, money-losing at the Bally's Twin River Lincoln Casino Resort near Providence. The goal was a bit of excitement and out-of-town fun, and the passengers on board seemed ready for both. As the bus snaked its way through Chinatown, a fe-

阅读简体中文版



Read in simplified Chinese

male tour guide handed out vouchers for free gambling and food.

A little over an hour later, the passengers bounded off the bus into the smoky entrance of Bally's. Many headed straight to the Asian card games of baccarat and pai-gow poker, where they laid down stacks of crisp, hundred-dollar bills on the green-felt tables. Others made their way to the hundreds of Asian-themed slot machines or food court, where they cashed in their vouchers for congee, dried scallops, and other Chinese delicacies.

Every 20 minutes from dawn until well
BET, Page A10

The \$4 billion industry in New England is hugely profitable, and its largest casinos, including Encore Boston Harbor, Mohegan Sun, Foxwoods Resort Casino, and Bally's Twin River, relentlessly target people of Asian descent, exploiting myths tied to cultural history despite research showing that Asians are no more likely to gamble than other racial and ethnic groups.

To celebrate the Lunar New Year in February, lion dancers marched through the Encore Boston Harbor casino along with drums.

Today, part one of three.

ROYALLY DISGUSTED



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Hundreds of thousands of Americans took to the streets Saturday, including in Boston (above), for the third incarnation of the “No Kings” rally against the actions of the Trump administration. **A4, B1.**

As the warm turns

Sunday: Breezy, not as cool. High 47-52, low 37-42.

Monday: Warmer, in 60s. Complete report, **C24.**

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More than 8 out of 10 BPS high school seniors are now on track to meet ‘Mass-Core’ graduation requirements. **B1.**

It’s the role of a lifetime and there’s no shortage of actors wanting to don the princely garments and poignant angst of Hamlet, critic Don Aucoin writes. **N1.**

The war in the Middle East expanded, with Iranian-backed Houthi rebels launching missiles at Israel. **A2.**

The collapse of a deal to fund security of the Homeland Security Department revealed fractures among Republican leaders in Congress. **A5.**

‘Machine learning can see differences . . . that the human eye can’t.’

BENJAMIN NEPHEW, *Worcester Polytechnic Institute*

AI raises hopes of earlier warning on Alzheimer’s

By **Jonathan Saltzman**
GLOBE STAFF

Researchers in Massachusetts are experimenting with artificial intelligence to detect signs of Alzheimer’s disease in its earliest stages, when symptoms of the dreaded illness may go unnoticed but newer drugs can modestly slow its progression.

Helping more people get diagnosed earlier could be a significant step forward in the fight against the memory-robbing disease. Currently, 90 percent of people in the earliest phase of

Alzheimer’s, called mild cognitive impairment, go undiagnosed in the United States, multiple studies show.

“The biggest opportunity to improve Alzheimer’s care isn’t in a new drug — it’s in noticing the earliest signs sooner,” said Dr. Lidia Moura, director of population health in the neurology department at Mass General Brigham.

In recent weeks, scientists at Worcester Polytechnic Institute have deployed AI to analyze subtle structural changes in brain

ALZHEIMER’S, Page A13

Trump lawyer wields the sharp end at Harvard

By **Hilary Burns**
GLOBE STAFF

She is a Dartmouth grad and tenacious lawyer who’s maybe as well known for the colorful beanies she knits as she is for her blistering performances on Fox News.

As head of civil rights enforcement in the Justice Department, Harmeet Dhillon is the force behind the Trump administration’s latest attacks on Harvard and point person for a controversial effort that is upending decades of legal orthodoxy.

Her critics say she and the administration are hellbent on undoing years of progress for marginalized groups by focusing on alleged discrimination against white people.

Dhillon, a Sikh immigrant from India, and allies say they are merely representing the interests of all Americans, giving literal meaning to Martin Luther King’s grand aspiration of not

DHILLON, Page A8

When another maestro was out of tune at the BSO

By **Mark Shanahan**
GLOBE STAFF

The cacophony enveloping Symphony Hall in the wake of the Boston Symphony Orchestra’s decision not to renew music director Andris Nelsons’ contract has been jarring, in part because such discord has been unusual in the organization’s 146-year history.

Unusual, but not unprecedented. Nelsons’ sacking has stirred memories of another acrimonious episode involving a Boston maestro: the famed composer John Williams and his angry — if brief — resignation as conductor of the Boston Pops Orchestra 40 years ago. That imbroglio, like the split with Nelsons, gave the pub-

lic a rare glimpse of the sturm and drang inside Symphony Hall and the sometimes uneasy partnership that exists between the conductor and the conducted.

“Any relationship between someone who has to be obeyed and the people who are the followers can be

WILLIAMS, Page A14